

COLLECTIVE BARGAINING AGREEMENT

Between

WESTERN NEVADA COLLEGE

and the

**NEVADA FACULTY ALLIANCE
WNC Chapter**

Academic Year 2024–2026

Effective: August 1, 2024

ARTICLE 1 – COMPENSATION AND SALARY

1.1 Salary Schedule

All full-time academic faculty employed by Western Nevada College shall be compensated in accordance with the Faculty Salary Schedule adopted by the Board of Regents. The salary schedule shall consist of ranks and steps reflecting years of service and academic qualifications. Placement on the salary schedule shall be determined at the time of hire based on verified prior academic experience, advanced degrees, and relevant professional credentials. Faculty shall advance one step on the salary schedule at the beginning of each academic year in which they render satisfactory service.

1.2 Annual Increases

The parties agree to the following salary increases for the duration of this agreement:

- Year 1 (2024–2025): A 3.0% across-the-board increase applied to base salary for all eligible faculty.
- Year 2 (2025–2026): A 2.5% across-the-board increase applied to base salary, subject to legislative appropriation and Board of Regents approval.
- Merit increases of up to 1.0% may be awarded annually based on performance evaluations rated as “Exceeds Expectations” or higher.

1.3 Additional Compensation

Faculty assigned to teach overload courses beyond their standard contract shall be compensated at a rate of no less than \$850 per credit hour. Summer session instruction shall be compensated at a rate agreed upon by the parties but no less than the overload rate.

Faculty who serve as department chairs or program coordinators shall receive a stipend of \$1,500 per semester in addition to their base salary. Specialized assignments such as curriculum development, accreditation leadership, or grant administration may qualify for additional stipends as approved by the College President.

1.4 Payroll

Faculty salaries shall be paid in equal installments on a biweekly basis over the duration of the academic contract period. Faculty may elect to receive salary payments distributed over twelve months by submitting a written election form to Human Resources no later than August 1 of each academic year.

ARTICLE 2 – EMPLOYEE BENEFITS

2.1 Health Insurance

The College shall provide eligible full-time faculty with access to group health insurance plans administered through the Nevada Public Employees' Benefits Program (PEBP). The College shall contribute the employer share of premiums as established by PEBP for the duration of this agreement. Faculty may enroll dependents and domestic partners in available plans subject to PEBP eligibility requirements.

2.2 Dental and Vision

The College shall offer dental and vision insurance coverage options through PEBP or a College-sponsored plan. Faculty may elect coverage during open enrollment periods. The College shall contribute a minimum of \$35 per month toward the combined dental and vision premium for the employee.

2.3 Retirement

Full-time faculty are eligible to participate in the Public Employees' Retirement System of Nevada (PERS) in accordance with state law. Both the College and the faculty member shall contribute to PERS at rates established by the PERS Board. Faculty hired after July 1, 2015 shall be enrolled in the Defined Contribution Plan unless they elect the Defined Benefit Plan within the election window.

2.4 Sick Leave and Medical Leave

Full-time faculty shall accrue sick leave at a rate of one (1) day per month of service, up to a maximum accrual of 90 days. Sick leave may be used for the faculty member's own illness, injury, or medical appointment, or to care for an immediate family member as defined by the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA).

Faculty who exhaust accrued sick leave may apply for additional unpaid medical leave of up to twelve (12) weeks per academic year under FMLA, subject to applicable federal and state requirements. The College shall maintain the faculty member's group health insurance coverage during approved FMLA leave.

2.5 Professional Development

The College recognizes the importance of ongoing faculty development. Each full-time faculty member shall be eligible for professional development funding of up to \$750 per academic year for conference attendance, course enrollment, or certification activities directly related to their teaching discipline. Applications shall be submitted to the appropriate Dean for approval no later than 30 days prior to the activity.

ARTICLE 3 – FACULTY WORKLOAD

3.1 Standard Teaching Load

The standard full-time faculty teaching load shall be fifteen (15) credit hours per semester, or thirty (30) credit hours per academic year. For laboratory or clinical courses, one laboratory hour shall be counted as two-thirds (2/3) of one credit hour for workload calculation purposes.

Faculty assigned to developmental education, co-requisite support courses, or dual enrollment sections may have workload calculated on an adjusted basis as agreed upon by the faculty member, their department chair, and the appropriate Dean.

3.2 Non-Teaching Duties

In recognition of the professional responsibilities of full-time faculty beyond direct instruction, each faculty member's contract shall include time allocated for the following:

- Student advising and office hours: a minimum of five (5) posted office hours per week during the academic year.
- Committee service: participation in at least one standing college or departmental committee per semester.
- Curriculum development: ongoing review and revision of course materials, syllabi, and program outcomes.
- Professional development activities consistent with Article 2.5 of this agreement.

3.3 Overload Assignments

No faculty member shall be required to teach an overload assignment. Overload teaching shall be voluntary and shall not exceed six (6) credit hours per semester without written approval from the faculty member and the appropriate Dean. Overload compensation is addressed in Article 1.3.

3.4 Schedule and Assignment

Class schedules shall be developed collaboratively between faculty and department chairs. Faculty shall be notified of their teaching assignments no later than six (6) weeks prior to the start of each semester. Changes to assignments after notification shall require mutual agreement unless necessitated by enrollment changes, course cancellations, or other exigent circumstances.

Faculty shall not be assigned to teach at more than two (2) campus locations on the same day without their written consent. Travel time between campuses shall be considered in scheduling and shall not be counted against office hour obligations.

ARTICLE 4 – GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

4.1 Purpose and Definitions

The purpose of this Article is to provide a fair and efficient process for the resolution of disputes arising under the terms of this Agreement. A grievance is defined as an allegation by a faculty member or the NFA that the College has violated, misapplied, or misinterpreted a specific provision of this Collective Bargaining Agreement.

Grievances shall not include matters of academic judgment, institutional policies not covered by this Agreement, or actions taken pursuant to state law or Board of Regents regulations that are outside the scope of bargaining.

4.2 Step One – Informal Resolution

Before filing a formal grievance, the faculty member is encouraged to discuss the alleged violation informally with their immediate supervisor within ten (10) calendar days of becoming aware of the issue. The supervisor shall respond informally within ten (10) calendar days of the discussion. If the matter is not resolved informally, the faculty member may proceed to Step Two.

4.3 Step Two – Formal Written Grievance

If the grievance is not resolved at Step One, the faculty member shall submit a written grievance to the appropriate Dean or Vice President within fifteen (15) calendar days of the supervisor's informal response or the expiration of the response period. The written grievance shall include:

- The specific article(s) and section(s) of the Agreement alleged to have been violated.
- A description of the facts giving rise to the grievance, including dates and names of individuals involved.
- The remedy requested by the grievant.

The Dean or Vice President shall schedule a meeting with the grievant and an NFA representative within ten (10) calendar days of receipt of the written grievance. A written response shall be issued within fifteen (15) calendar days following the meeting.

4.4 Step Three – Arbitration

If the grievance is not resolved at Step Two, the NFA may submit the grievance to binding arbitration within thirty (30) calendar days of receiving the Step Two response. The parties shall select a neutral arbitrator through the American Arbitration Association (AAA) or the Federal Mediation and Conciliation Service (FMCS) using the list procedure.

The arbitrator shall have authority to interpret and apply the provisions of this Agreement but shall have no authority to add to, subtract from, or modify any term of the Agreement. The decision of the arbitrator shall be final and binding on both parties. Costs of arbitration shall be shared equally by the College and the NFA.

4.5 Time Limits and Waivers

Failure by the grievant or the NFA to comply with the time limits set forth in this Article shall result in the grievance being deemed withdrawn. Failure by the College to respond within the time limits shall allow the grievant to advance the grievance to the next step. Time limits may be extended by mutual written agreement of the parties.

— End of Agreement —

This is a fictional contract generated by Claude AI based on a real collective bargaining agreement. Reference: Bassen, Rachele. (April 13, 2025). WNC-NFA sample contract [AI-generated document]. Claude (Anthropic). <https://claude.ai>